

Terms & Conditions

Gipfel Limited Terms & Conditions

1. Operator

Gipfel Limited trading as Gilbert's Group | Appetite Journeys is a tour operator based in Dunedin, New Zealand, specialising in small group tours to Europe, with a particular focus on Switzerland.

2. Acknowledgement

By completing the Tour Registration Form, you acknowledge and accept these Terms and Conditions, as well as any other terms, services, inclusion and exclusions that form part of each tour, as part of the terms of travel.

3. Deposit

A non-refundable "lifetime" deposit is required at the time of booking. "Lifetime deposit" means this can be transferred to another tour up until 90 days before your original tour departure date.

- Should a major event occur which precludes international travel, the deposit will be refunded.
- For cancellations made between 89 and 50 days before tour departure, 50% of the tour cost (less non-refundable deposit) will be made.
- For cancellations made within 49 days of departure, no refunds will be made.

4. Payment dates

- Deposit (see clause 3 for details) when booking is made.
- Full payment no later than 90 days before tour departure.

5. Cancellation

We reserve the right to cancel any tour, for example if minimum guest numbers are not met. In this case, you are entitled to a full refund; or you can choose to use funds towards a future tour.

6. Pricing

Tour costs are correct as posted online at any stage. Final payments due may change depending on currency fluctuations at the time payment is made.

7. Solo travellers

Tour pricing is based on twin-share arrangements. Solo travellers are required to pay the solo supplement as outlined in the tour information.

8. Passport

Your passport must be valid for at least 6 months after the end of your tour. We will require a copy of your passport.

9. Visa

It is your responsibility to ensure you have visas and any other permits required to visit the countries included in your itinerary.

10. Travel insurance

You are required to have comprehensive travel insurance in place. We recommend this is purchased at the time you book your trip.

11. Arrival/departure travel

This is not included in any tour and you are responsible for ensuring you will arrive at your first location by the date and time specified on your tour itinerary.

12. Age

The minimum age for our tours is 15; all guests under the age of 18 must be accompanied by a guardian. If you are over 75, we may ask for proof of medical clearance to travel.

13. Health issues

It is your responsibility to ensure your vaccinations are current. We cannot provide any assistance with this and recommend you discuss this with your medical professional.

14. Communication

You are requested to join a tour WhatsApp group to enable ease and timeliness of communication. This will be set up about two weeks before departure.

15. Luggage

Please keep luggage to a minimum. We recommend no more than one suitcase of 23kg, and hand luggage. You must be able to carry and handle your own luggage at all times.

16. Smoking/vaping

Smoking and vaping are not permitted on any of our tour transport, hotel rooms, restaurant or in the general vicinity of group members.

17. Exclusions

Our tour prices do not include extras such as visa fees | personal items | meals, drinks and activities not included in the itinerary | vaccinations | tips/gratuities | laundry | mini bar | data | insurance.

18. Use of images

You agree that we can use any photo, video or other imagery created during the tour. This includes any media available on the WhatsApp group. Please advise if you do not grant permission for this.

19. Authority

You are expected to respect the authority of your guides. The guides' decision is final on all matters likely to affect the safety and wellbeing of any member of the tour group. You must comply with local laws and regulations at all times.

20. Respect

We ask you to be kind and show respect. Rude, aggressive or abusive behaviour will not be tolerated, and if we are unable to resolve any issues, may result in cancellation of a booking. Unacceptable behaviour includes, but is not limited to: bullying, use of offensive language, threats and discrimination | making ongoing unreasonable demands and/or complaints | generally disruptive behaviour and/or causing communication problems.

21. Values

You are expected to join us in demonstrating high values. This includes, but is not limited to: respecting the environment, local cultures, guides, and other guests | dressing or behaving appropriately according to local customs.

22. Safety

We prioritise the group's safety and enjoyment. We may need to take action, or ask a guest to leave a tour, where behaviour puts anyone at risk. This includes, but is not limited to: ignoring instructions from guides | engaging in reckless, illegal or dangerous behaviour | unmanaged mental health issues that might pose a risk. Dangerous and/or illegal activity will result in immediate removal from the tour, and possible reporting to local authorities.

23. No refunds

There will be no refunds provided where a guest does not use all parts of a tour. This includes early departure (for any reason), or choosing to not partake in accommodation, travel or meals provided as part of the itinerary.

24. Voiding of agreement

Your contract with us may be terminated without notice if you do not comply with all reasonable and legal requests. This includes, but is not limited to: not signing required liability waivers | providing false information during the booking process | using suspicious or fraudulent payment methods | not meeting payment deadlines or providing necessary documents | failing to have a valid passport, visas, or necessary permits | not sharing essential safety and trip coordination information with us.

25. Legal jurisdiction

These terms and conditions, and any contract to which they apply, are governed by New Zealand law.

26. Disclaimers

- We act solely as facilitator of travel experiences and do not own or operate any of the accommodation or activity providers used during any tour.
- We cannot be held liable for any injury, loss, damage, accident, delay, or irregularity that may occur due to circumstances beyond our control. This includes, but is not limited to, changes made by third-party service providers, weather events, political disruptions, or health-related incidents.
- Itineraries are subject to change at any time due to local conditions or operational requirements. We reserve the right to alter or substitute activities, accommodation or transportation where necessary, always with the aim of maintaining the quality and intent of the overall experience.
- We cannot be held liable if a participant is refused entry into a country due to lack of valid passport, visa, vaccinations or other travel documentation.